

How To Exposé



The synopsis is a work plan for a writing project that can be used to plan the next steps. It is therefore an intermediate step in the writing process. It helps to deal with the topic of the future term paper at an early stage. An initial examination of the existing literature also makes it clear whether the state of research is sufficient to deal with the planned question.

It is important to note that the synopsis is not a definitive timetable that must be adhered to. The approach and ideas can and may change again and again during the writing process. However, any major changes should be discussed with the teacher.

The synopsis contains information about you (cover sheet with name, e-mail address, matriculation number, degree program and semester). It should provide an overview of the topic, the research question and objective, the work steps and the basic literature.

The presentation of the topic and research question is therefore followed by a description of the research interest: Why is the selected topic relevant? This is followed by a description of the sources and materials and how (methods, literature review) the question is to be answered. For example, will a phenomenon be described or two aspects compared?

When writing an exposé, it should be written like a scientific paper - in a clear, precise and straightforward style.

For a term paper, a synopsis should not be much longer than two pages; for a thesis, it should be correspondingly longer.

Even more detailed information and a checklist can be found in the [Bielefeld University](#) guidelines.

